

deductions generated by the business loss? Maybe your mother hasn't explored all her medical options?

As for B, I think it's a good option, with a few caveats. You never want to be the one who pulls other people into a financial morass no one can get out of. So make sure your parents initiate that discussion with others themselves. But sharing the burden among family does lessen the load for everyone. Ultimately, it's everyone's choice whether to help, but this plan also encourages transparency, which is one of the best ways to straighten out financially and remove the shame from bad money management decisions.

And if you chose C, then I worry for your Money Karma. And your money is worried, too. It knows it's vulnerable from here on in to any and all requests to be depleted, and you had better have a good backup plan yourself, because midlife loans of this caliber *will* wipe out your savings. If you have the extra money, fine, write the check. But as I mentioned before, best not to expect to see that money again.

- 3. Two of your closest friends have started a small catering business in their midfifties. It's doing pretty well; you even work a function here and there for extra money. But with another \$50,000 investment, they say they could have their own kitchen and really expand the business. They've approached you to become a partner. You decide to:**
- a) take a pass, but you'll hire them for your retirement party.
It's just too much money for you to part with this late in the game. And you're not sure you want to be an entrepreneur after years on a salary. Besides, for every Martha Stewart (who didn't hit big until her forties), there are hundreds, if not thousands, of failed caterers who couldn't differentiate enough to break through.
 - b) take it under consideration, but offer a smaller financial commitment of \$15,000, increasing your investment as the returns come in. After all, change is good, and you trust these friends to really make a go of it.
 - c) take a chance on being part of a new venture. You always fancied yourself an entrepreneur, and what better time to